IBPS SO

IT OFFICER
6-MONTH DETAILED ROADMAP

A structured preparation system for Professional Knowledge, Prelims, mocks and interview readiness

Plan duration	10 November 2026 - 9 May 2027 (180 days)
Starting level	Beginner to intermediate
Primary objective	Build exam readiness for the next available IBPS SO IT Officer cycle
Fixed commitment	College paper preparation: 8:45 AM - 11:45 AM
Parallel objective	Keep campus-placement skills active through DSA and backend practice

IMPORTANT ELIGIBILITY CHECK

IBPS SO IT Officer Scale I requires a qualifying completed degree (as specified in the relevant notification) by its stated eligibility cut-off date. If your B.Tech is still in progress, preparation is useful, but you may not yet be eligible to apply. Verify the next notification before making an application decision.

This is a preparation plan, not a prediction of the next exam date. The 2027 cycle dates, pattern, eligibility cut-off, syllabus details and vacancies must be checked in the next official IBPS notification.

1. Exam strategy and preparation priorities

The IBPS SO IT Officer selection process has three broad stages: Online Preliminary Examination, Online Main Examination (Professional Knowledge) and Interview. The preliminary examination is qualifying for shortlisting to the Main examination; final selection rules and weightage must be read from the current cycle notification.

Reference exam structure (verify against the next notification)

Prelims	English Language; Reasoning; Quantitative Aptitude	150 questions; 125 marks; 120 minutes overall, with sectional timing in the recent pattern
Mains	Professional Knowledge for IT Officer	60 questions; 60 marks; 45 minutes in the recent pattern
Interview	Technical fundamentals, banking/IT awareness, projects, communication and role understanding	Shortlisting and final weightage as specified in the notification

Preparation allocation

IBPS SO	70%	Technical knowledge, Prelims aptitude, English, current affairs, mocks and interview
Placement maintenance	20%	DSA and backend development; maintain momentum without taking time from IBPS
Review / buffer	10%	Error-log revision, missed targets and weekly planning

Non-negotiable rule: prepare Prelims and Mains in parallel from Day 1. Do not postpone Professional Knowledge until after Prelims.

Eligibility note for an in-progress B.Tech

The IT Officer notification has historically required a qualifying degree in a specified IT/computer/electronics-related discipline (or an accepted equivalent qualification). The degree must be completed by the notification's stated cut-off date. An in-progress B.Tech generally does not satisfy a completed-degree requirement. Check the exact accepted branches, result date and cut-off in the next notification.

2. Daily timetable (college paper slot preserved)

Use this timetable on normal study days. It keeps the 8:45 AM-11:45 AM college-paper block unchanged and leaves a small placement-maintenance block.

6:30-7:00	Wake up, water, freshen up	Start consistently
7:00-8:30	**IBPS IT Professional Knowledge**	New concept + notes
8:30-8:45	Break	Reset
8:45-11:45	**College paper preparation**	Fixed academic commitment
11:45-12:30	Lunch and rest	Recovery
12:30-1:30	**Reasoning or Quantitative Aptitude**	Alternate focus by day
1:30-2:00	**English**	Reading, grammar or questions
2:00-2:30	Rest	Recovery
2:30-3:30	**IT MCQs / PYQs / topic test**	Retrieval practice
3:30-4:00	Break	Reset
4:00-5:00	DSA or Backend development (alternate days)	Placement maintenance
5:00-6:30	Exercise / personal time	Health and recovery
6:30-7:30	Dinner and refresh	Break
7:30-8:30	**IT revision / mock analysis**	Consolidation
8:30-9:00	Banking/current affairs or English revision	Awareness and retention
9:00-9:20	Error notebook + plan tomorrow	Close the day
10:30 PM	**Sleep**	Aim for 7-8 hours

Daily minimum if you have a difficult day

- 60 minutes Professional Knowledge (revision or one subtopic).
- 30 minutes Prelims practice (Quant/Reasoning/English).
- 30 minutes technical MCQs and error-log review.
- Do not try to compensate for a missed day by sacrificing sleep. Resume the plan the next day.

3. Weekly study cycle

Repeat this weekly structure throughout the six months. The exact topic changes by month, but the rhythm stays stable.

Monday	Quant	New technical topic	20-30 topic MCQs + error log
Tuesday	Reasoning	Continue technical topic	Recall notes without looking
Wednesday	English	New technical topic	Sectional test + analysis
Thursday	Quant	Technical topic + diagrams	Timed question set
Friday	Reasoning	Technical revision	Mixed MCQs from old topics
Saturday	Mixed Prelims practice	Weekly technical test	Repair the 2 weakest areas
Sunday	Full/sectional mock	Mains-style technical test	Detailed mock analysis + next-week plan

Weekly minimum targets

Professional Knowledge MCQs	150-200	Tag each wrong answer by topic and reason
Quant + Reasoning	100-120 questions	Use timed sets; review shortcuts and errors
English	5 sessions	Reading + grammar + timed practice
Mock tests	2-3 sectional/full tests	Analysis time should be at least the test time
Current affairs	6 short sessions	Focus on banking, finance, economy and technology
Placement maintenance	3 DSA + 2 development sessions	Keep it bounded to the planned hour

Mock analysis checklist

- Was the error caused by a concept gap, misreading, calculation, guess or time pressure?
- Could the question be solved faster with a known method?
- Write the corrected method in one or two lines.
- Reattempt the question after 48 hours and again after 7 days.
- Track accuracy and time by section; do not judge progress by total score alone.

MONTH 1 | 10 NOV - 9 DEC 2026 | FOUNDATION

Objective: build a clean base and diagnose your current level. Learn the basics carefully; do not rush into advanced topics.

Professional Knowledge

- DBMS: data vs information, database architecture, ER model, relational model, keys, constraints.
- Operating Systems: OS functions, process vs thread, process states, system calls, scheduling overview.
- Computer Networks: network types, topologies, OSI model, TCP/IP model, basic devices.
- Programming/OOP: variables, data types, control flow, functions, classes, objects, four pillars of OOP.

Prelims

- Quant: simplification/approximation, number series, percentages, ratio-proportion, averages.
- Reasoning: inequality, syllogism, direction, blood relations, alphanumeric series, order/ranking.
- English: parts of speech, subject-verb agreement, tenses, articles, prepositions, basic reading comprehension.

Weekly measurable output

- Take one baseline Prelims mock in Week 1 and record section-wise score, accuracy and time.
- Complete 300-350 technical MCQs by month end; target 70%+ accuracy on topics already studied.
- Complete 4 sectional tests (at least one each in Quant, Reasoning, English and IT).
- Create four notebooks/files: technical short notes, formula sheet, error log and current-affairs notes.

	Target / evidence
Baseline	One full Prelims mock with section-wise analysis
Technical practice	300-350 MCQs; accuracy tracked by subject
Syllabus	DBMS, OS, CN and OOP foundations covered
Revision	Short notes and error log created

MONTH 2 | 10 DEC 2026 - 9 JAN 2027 | CORE IT

Objective: move from definitions to application-based questions. Begin timed practice in every Prelims section.

Professional Knowledge

- DBMS: normalization (1NF-BCNF), SQL commands, joins, subqueries, views, indexes, transactions, ACID, concurrency and recovery.
- Operating Systems: CPU scheduling algorithms, synchronization, semaphores, deadlocks, paging, segmentation, virtual memory and file systems.
- Computer Networks: IPv4/IPv6 basics, subnetting, TCP vs UDP, DNS, DHCP, HTTP/HTTPS, SMTP, FTP, routing and switching.
- Data Structures: arrays, linked lists, stacks, queues, hashing, searching and sorting; time complexity basics.

Prelims

- Quant: profit-loss, discount, simple/compound interest, time and work, pipes, speed-distance-time.
- Reasoning: linear/circular seating, floor and box puzzles, scheduling puzzles, coding-decoding, data sufficiency.
- English: cloze test, error detection, sentence improvement, para jumbles and RC.

Weekly measurable output

- Complete 400 additional technical MCQs; revise Month 1 topics twice.
- Complete 2 timed Prelims sectional tests each week by the end of the month.
- Target 70-75% accuracy in familiar technical topics; log every guess and negative-marking risk.
- Write SQL queries by hand or in a local database for joins, grouping, subqueries and constraints.

	Target / evidence
Technical practice	400 additional MCQs
Syllabus	DBMS, OS, CN and DS core completed once
Prelims	At least 2 timed sectionals weekly near month-end
Revision	Month 1 topics revised twice

MONTH 3 | 10 JAN - 9 FEB 2027 | PROGRAMMING + SYSTEMS

Objective: finish the high-value core CS areas and start mixed-topic technical tests.

Professional Knowledge

- Data Structures and Algorithms: trees, BST, heaps, graphs, BFS/DFS, recursion, hashing, sorting/searching complexity.
- OOP and programming: inheritance, polymorphism, abstraction, encapsulation, constructors, overloading/overriding, pointers, memory, exceptions.
- Software Engineering: SDLC, Agile, Scrum, requirements, design, testing levels, verification/validation, maintenance, version control.
- Computer Organization: number systems, Boolean logic, CPU, registers, instruction cycle, memory hierarchy, cache, I/O and interrupts.
- Microprocessor basics: 8085/8086 architecture, registers, addressing modes and interrupts at overview level.

Prelims

- Quant: mixtures, partnership, averages advanced, time-work advanced, data interpretation (tables, bar, line and pie).
- Reasoning: input-output, statement-assumption/conclusion, cause-effect, coded inequalities and advanced puzzles.
- English: RC inference, fillers, phrase replacement, sentence rearrangement and vocabulary in context.

Weekly measurable output

- Complete 450-500 technical MCQs and 2 mixed technical tests per week in the final two weeks.
- Finish the first pass of the core IT syllabus; make a one-page revision sheet per subject.
- Complete one full Prelims mock every week and analyze it fully.
- Target a stable improvement over your Month 1 baseline rather than chasing an arbitrary score.

	Target / evidence
Technical practice	450-500 additional MCQs
Syllabus	First pass of core IT syllabus completed
Prelims	One full mock every week
Revision	One-page notes for each major subject

MONTH 4 | 10 FEB - 9 MAR 2027 | SPECIALIST IT + BANKING

Objective: cover specialist and applied topics, connect IT concepts to banking systems and improve speed.

Professional Knowledge

- Information Security: CIA triad, threats, vulnerabilities, malware, phishing, access control, authentication, authorization, firewalls, IDS/IPS, backups and incident response.
- Cryptography: symmetric/asymmetric encryption, hashing, digital signatures, certificates, PKI, TLS/SSL concepts.
- Web technologies: client-server, HTML/CSS/JavaScript basics, HTTP methods/status codes, REST APIs, cookies, sessions, JSON and web security.
- Cloud and infrastructure: IaaS/PaaS/SaaS, public/private/hybrid cloud, virtualization, containers, storage, availability and disaster recovery.
- Banking IT: CBS, NEFT, RTGS, IMPS, UPI, cards, ATM/POS, internet/mobile banking, NPCI, payment security, KYC/AML basics and cybersecurity in banks.
- Emerging tech: AI/ML fundamentals, blockchain, IoT, big data and data privacy.

Prelims

- Quant: DI sets, probability, permutation-combination basics, quadratic equations and missing/wrong number series.
- Reasoning: advanced puzzles, data sufficiency, logical reasoning and mixed sectional sets.
- English: timed RC, cloze, para jumbles, word usage and grammar revision.

Weekly measurable output

- Complete 500-600 technical MCQs this month, including banking IT and security questions.
- Complete at least 4 full Prelims mocks during the month.
- Take one 45-minute Professional Knowledge mock every week.
- Create a concise banking technology glossary and revise it twice weekly.

	Target / evidence
Technical practice	500-600 additional MCQs
Syllabus	Security, web, cloud and banking IT covered
Mocks	4 full Prelims + 4 technical mocks
Revision	Banking IT glossary revised twice weekly

MONTH 5 | 10 MAR - 9 APR 2027 | REVISION + EXAM PRACTICE

Objective: convert knowledge into marks. Reduce passive video watching; increase timed tests, retrieval and error correction.

Professional Knowledge

- Revise DBMS, OS, CN, DS, OOP, Software Engineering, COA, Security, Web, Cloud and Banking IT.
- Solve previous-year questions and reputable memory-based questions; label questions by concept and difficulty.
- Revisit all low-accuracy topics; do not spend equal time on already-mastered areas.
- Practice mixed sets where topics are not announced in advance.

Prelims

- Quant: mixed arithmetic + DI; prioritize accuracy before speed.
- Reasoning: mixed puzzles and non-puzzle questions; develop a question-selection strategy.
- English: RC and mixed grammar/vocabulary sets under time limits.
- Practice section-wise time management according to the current official exam interface and notification.

Weekly measurable output

- Complete 600-700 technical MCQs this month, including at least 2 mixed technical tests each week.
- Take 2 full Prelims mocks per week and review them in detail.
- Take 1-2 Professional Knowledge mocks per week.
- Prepare a final 20-30 page revision pack: formulas, protocols, SQL, OS algorithms, security terms and common traps.

	Target / evidence
Technical practice	600-700 additional MCQs
Mocks	8 full Prelims + 4-8 technical mocks
Weakness repair	Every recurring error has a correction note
Revision	Final revision pack ready

MONTH 6 | 10 APR - 9 MAY 2027 | FINAL CONSOLIDATION

Objective: become test-ready, protect accuracy and build interview confidence. This is not the month to start many new resources.

Professional Knowledge

- Revise all short notes in cycles: weak topics first, then medium, then strong topics.
- Take timed 60-question/45-minute practice sets as a reference to the recent pattern; verify the next notification.
- Reattempt wrong questions from the error log and explain the concept aloud.
- Practice interview explanations for DBMS, OS, CN, security, banking systems and your own projects.

Prelims

- Take 2-3 full Prelims mocks per week if recovery and analysis time permit.
- After each mock, classify errors and set a specific repair task for the next day.
- Keep English reading practice daily; rotate Quant and Reasoning timed sets.
- Do not make drastic strategy changes in the final 10 days of a confirmed exam.

Weekly measurable output

- Take 8-10 full Prelims mocks across the month, with full analysis.
- Take 6-8 Professional Knowledge mocks across the month.
- Aim for stable performance above your own earlier scores; do not treat any unofficial score as a guaranteed cutoff.
- Prepare a 60-second introduction, project walkthroughs and answers to why banking/why IT Officer.

	Target / evidence
Mocks	8-10 full Prelims + 6-8 technical mocks
Accuracy	Stable and improving section-wise performance
Interview	Introduction + 3 project/technical walkthroughs
Readiness	All short notes and error-log questions revised

10. How to practice each subject

IT Professional Knowledge	Concept -> short notes -> 30-50 MCQs -> timed topic test -> error review -> 7-day retest	Accuracy by topic; repeated error count
Quant	Learn one method; solve untimed examples; then 10-15 question timed sets; review calculation shortcuts	Accuracy, average time, skipped questions
Reasoning	Master puzzle formats one at a time; draw tables/diagrams; practice non-puzzle questions for quick marks	Puzzle completion time and accuracy
English	Daily reading; grammar rule revision; timed RC/cloze/error-detection sets; review why options are wrong	Accuracy by question type and reading speed
Current affairs	Use one monthly source; revise weekly; focus on banking, finance, economy, RBI, digital payments and IT	Weekly recall quiz score

Score tracking sheet

_____	_____	____	____%	_____	_____
_____	_____	____	____%	_____	_____
_____	_____	____	____%	_____	_____
_____	_____	____	____%	_____	_____
_____	_____	____	____%	_____	_____
_____	_____	____	____%	_____	_____

Suggested performance milestones (not official cutoffs)

1	Baseline established; improve section balance	Core concepts understood; topic accuracy measured
2	Timed sectionals; reduce avoidable errors	70%+ accuracy on familiar topics
3	Weekly full mock; stable attempt strategy	Mixed-topic tests introduced
4	4 full mocks/month; section-wise review	45-minute technical mock each week
5	2 full mocks/week; improve consistency	Mixed tests and PYQs; weak areas repaired
6	2-3 full mocks/week if properly analyzed	Timed tests, revision and interview explanations

11. Interview preparation and banking awareness

Start light interview preparation in Month 3, then increase it in Months 5-6. Do not wait for the Main result to understand your own projects and technical fundamentals.

Technical interview question bank to prepare

- DBMS: normalization, indexing, transactions, ACID, joins, SQL query explanation and database security.
- OS: process vs thread, deadlock conditions, scheduling, paging, virtual memory and synchronization.
- Networks: TCP vs UDP, DNS, HTTPS/TLS, subnetting, firewalls and common network attacks.
- Security: encryption vs hashing, digital signatures, MFA, phishing, access control and incident response.
- Banking IT: Core Banking Solution, UPI, NEFT, RTGS, IMPS, ATM/POS, NPCI, payment security and customer data protection.
- Projects: problem statement, architecture, database schema, API design, security, deployment, challenges, trade-offs and what you personally implemented.

Interview preparation outputs

- A 60-90 second self-introduction.
- A 2-minute explanation of each major project, including architecture and your contribution.
- Five examples of debugging, teamwork, learning quickly and handling responsibility.
- A clear answer to: Why IT Officer in a bank? Why not only a software-company role?
- A short weekly update on RBI, digital banking, cybersecurity incidents, payment systems and important banking developments.

12. Resource strategy

Official exam details	Read the latest IBPS Specialist Officers notification and corrigenda first. Use IBPS mock interface/sample material where available.
IT concepts	Use one main course/source per subject (e.g., Gate Smashers or Neso Academy for core CS concepts). Make your own concise notes.
Technical MCQs	Use a reliable SO IT question bank and previous-year/memory-based papers. Cross-check disputed answers with textbooks or trusted documentation.
Prelims mocks	Choose one established test series (such as Oliveboard or PracticeMock) and stay with it long enough to measure improvement.
Current affairs	One monthly banking/economy current-affairs source plus RBI/NPCI/IBPS official updates. Avoid following many daily channels.

13. Mistakes to avoid

- Do not study only IT and ignore Prelims sectional cutoffs/qualifying requirements.
- Do not postpone Professional Knowledge until after Prelims.
- Do not watch long lectures passively. After each concept, close the video and solve questions.
- Do not attempt mocks without analysis; an unreviewed mock has limited value.
- Do not collect multiple books, courses and test series. Finish one resource before adding another.
- Do not chase a fixed mock score as if it were an official cutoff. Cutoffs vary by cycle, category, vacancies and paper difficulty.

- Do not sacrifice sleep or skip all exercise to add more study hours.

14. Final execution checklist

■ 90 min IT concept study ■ 60 min Quant/Reasoning ■ 30 min English ■ 60 min IT MCQs/PYQs ■ 60 min IT revision/mock analysis ■ 15-20 min current affairs ■ Error log updated	■ 150-200 IT MCQs ■ 100-120 Quant/Reasoning questions ■ 5 English sessions ■ 2-3 mocks/sectionals ■ Mock analysis completed ■ Weak-topic repair ■ Next week planned	■ Syllabus progress reviewed ■ Old topics retested ■ Mock trend checked ■ Accuracy by subject reviewed ■ Notes compressed ■ Resource list controlled ■ Eligibility/notification checked

Official references and verification

IBPS Specialist Officers XVI official page: https://www.ibps.in/index.php/specialist-officers-xvi/

IBPS official website and recruitment updates: https://www.ibps.in/

IBPS tentative 2026-27 calendar (historical cycle reference): Official calendar PDF

Recent detailed notification (reference only; not a substitute for the next cycle notification): CRP SPL-XV notification PDF

The next recruitment cycle may change dates, pattern, syllabus wording, eligibility cut-off, vacancies, interview weightage or other rules. Always follow the latest official notification and corrigenda.

Your rule for all 180 days

Learn one concept. Solve questions on it. Review every mistake. Revisit it after a few days. Repeat. Consistency and measured improvement matter more than collecting study hours.